



How to submit a report on the Child Sexual Exploitation & Abuse Industry Reporting Portal (CSEA-IRP) using the API function

A practical guide to help individuals navigate and use the CSEA-IRP API function

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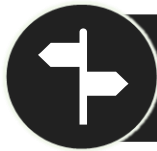
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Using this guide

Employees of a user-to-user service or third-party reporting child sexual exploitation and abuse (CSEA) to the National Crime Agency (NCA) on behalf of an organisation via the CSEA Industry Reporting Portal (CSEA-IRP). The reporting service is available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week but Organisation registration requests are only reviewed and processed during working hours (Monday – Friday 07:00–17:00, excluding weekends and UK bank holidays).

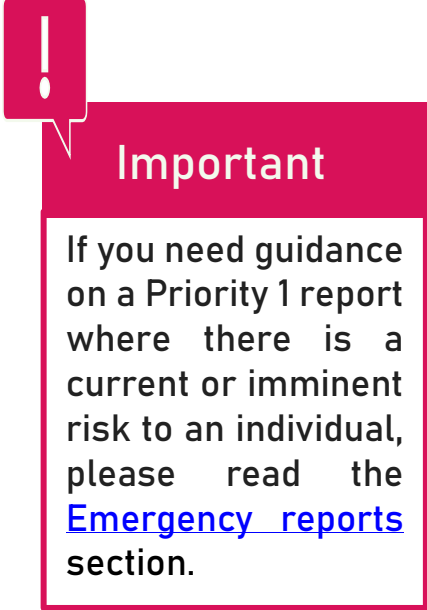
Once you have identified a CSEA offence (listed as part of [Schedule 6](#) of the Online Safety Act (OSA) 2023) on your organisation's service, please provide as much relevant information as possible relating to the suspected offence and the users involved when making a report. This will allow law enforcement agencies to identify offenders and safeguard victims.

This guide will help you to understand the process for submitting individual CSEA reports to the NCA via the CSEA-IRP and will provide you with:

- an overview of the portal
- an overview of the submission process
- information on the type of questions you will be asked when submitting reports

Registering an individual user:

If you are an Organisation Administrator and require guidance on how to register an individual user within your organisation to use the CSEA-IRP, please refer to the “How to register an individual user” guidance. This guidance would have been provided to the original Organisation Administrator when your organisation first registered to use the portal.



Important

If you need guidance on a Priority 1 report where there is a current or imminent risk to an individual, please read the [Emergency reports](#) section.

Pre-requisites

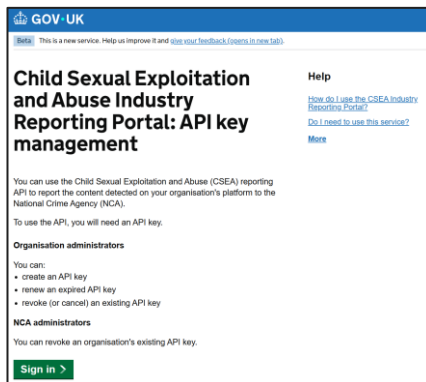
There are two ways your organisation can report CSEA through the CSEA-IRP;

- manually submit individual reports through the web portal
- submit reports in bulk automatically through our Application Programming Interface (API)

This guide will focus on how to automatically submit individual reports to the CSEA-IRP via the API.

In order to submit reports via the API, your organisation must already have an account on the CSEA-IRP platform and the user creating the API must have admin privileges for this organisation. This user should navigate to the following link to begin the process:

[API Key Management Portal](#)



! Generating an API code (1)

In order to submit reports via the CSEA IRP API, the user with administrator privileges must navigate to the following site and sign-in as they would to the standard portal site:

[API Key Management Portal](#)



From this page, the user can create an API key, revoke the existing key, and renew the same key. Here they can also find their organisation ID which is required for the API submission.

! Generating an API code (2)

Upon generating an API key, the user must copy this and store within 1 minute before it is removed from the screen. This key should be held somewhere safe, and not shared unless necessary for API setup.

The NCA and any of its partnered organisations will NEVER ask for your API key. Please be aware that this key should be considered with the same security as a password.



!

Navigating to Swagger

The API documentation for this application is provided in the form of Swagger architecture. To navigate to the Swagger page, click the ‘Access API documentation’ found in both the api-key-management section and the reporting home page.

CSEA Industry Reporting Portal Registration

Beta

This is a new service. Help us improve it and [give your feedback \(opens in new tab\)](#).

Sign out

Organisation Admin

Your organisation ID

You have 1 active API key. If you have forgotten your API key, you can revoke and renew it below.

Creation date	Expiration date	Status
2026-03-02	2026-08-29	Active (In use)

Create API key

Create a new API key for your organisation to use the Child Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (CSEA) reporting API.

Revoke API key

Revoke (or cancel) your existing API key.

Renew API key

Renew an API key for your organisation that has expired or is about to expire.

Access API documentation

Swagger

/home/api-docs

Explore

CSEA-IRP Submission API Documentation

1.0 OAS 3.0

/home/api-docs

CSEA-IRP Submission service API Resource Endpoint(s) with description

Servers

https://internal-dev.uk-child-sexual-abuse-industry-reporting.gov.uk/submission - Generated server url

submission-controller

POST /api/referral/ Submit API Referral

Schemas

CreateAPIReferralRequest >

SubmissionPayload >

ReferralResponse >

! Using the submission-controller

The submission-controller allows users to input their unique API Key and orgID. Upon clicking 'Try it out' the fields will become interactable and the request body will automatically fill with a standard, acceptable API call, as well as allowing upload of a file. Users can use this to send dummy reports, after which the Responses section will display whether the call was acceptable or not. This service is not intended to be used for sending genuine reports which must be done via an organisation's own API capabilities.

submission-controller

POST /api/referral/ Submit API Referral

Creates a new referral submission from an external API consumer. Requires a valid API key and the reporting organisation's UUID.

Parameters

Try it out

Name	Description
X-API-KEY • required	API key issued to the reporting organisation
string (header)	X-API-KEY
orgId • required	UUID of the reporting organisation
string (header)	orgId

Request body required

multipart/form-data

submission • required

Structure of the JSON string passed in the submission field

object

uploadedFiles

array

Responses

Code	Description	Links
200	OK	No links

Media type

application/json

Controls Accept header.

Example Value | Schema

```
{
  "success": true,
  "referralID": "f8d564-5727-4562-b8fc-2c9d3f6e5a4d",
  "referralFriendlyID": "string",
  "reportID": 0
}
```


! Accessing the API schemas

Within the Swagger page, users can find the API schemas used to create a successful API call. Clicking through the arrows displays the different fields to complete, how they are laid out, and if there are any validations such as mandatory fields.



The screenshot displays the 'Schemas' section of a Swagger API documentation page. It contains three expandable schema definitions:

- CreateAPIReferralRequest** (description: Multipart form data for API referral submission)
 - submission* (required) → SubmissionPayload > {...}
 - uploadedFiles → > [...]
- SubmissionPayload** (description: Structure of the JSON string passed in the submission field)
 - about* (required) → > [...]
 - priorityId* (required) → > [...]
 - reportedInformation → > {...}
 - friendlyReferralId → > [...]
 - potentialMemeReport → > [...]
 - referralId → > [...]
 - userId → > [...]
- ReferralResponse**
 - success → > [...]
 - referralID → > [...]
 - referralFriendlyID → > [...]
 - reportID → > [...]

This can be used to craft an organisations API call, then tested with the aforementioned submission-main section. Organisations will then be able to send successful API calls using their own architecture.



Priority level definitions

Priority 1 - current or immediate risk to an individual: this should be selected when there is an identified real and immediate threat to a loss of life or to cause serious harm or injury, which includes serious sexual assault and rape. This also includes where a child has been identified as needing immediate safeguarding as the abuse is currently taking place or there is imminent risk of abuse.



If you need to make an emergency report, please refer to the Emergency reports section (next page).

Priority 2 - possible risk to an individual in the near future or is time-sensitive: this should be selected when safeguarding action is needed urgently but there is no immediate threat. This could be for example, where you believe that potential contact offending has taken place or you have detected content which indicates recently generated images. This also includes reports where a child has produced self-generated images or has received/sent child sexual abuse material.

Priority 3 - other: this should be selected when there is no impending danger to a child. This could include known images or URLs that have matched against a hash list and/or problematic chat has been detected with no sharing of child abuse material. This could also include material being shared amongst known adults where the ages of the individuals within the material are indeterminate, unless there is an immediate threat to life.

! Emergency reports

If you have detected a Priority 1 (P1) where there is information which suggests that there is an immediate threat to a child's life, or immediate risk of serious harm to a child, or you have directed a Priority 2 (P2) which suggests possible risk to a child in the near future or is time-sensitive; it is important that you submit this report immediately. To ensure we can access these reports as quickly as possible there are slight differences in submission processes dependent on the time of day (GMT):

Between 07:00 and 17:00 (GMT)

- For P1 reports: – Submit into portal (no follow up call needed). You can select “data not held” for any mandatory data fields if you do not yet have that information to hand. You can provide the missing data later by submitting a supplementary report. Once the report has been submitted, you can submit a [supplementary report](#) through the portal with any missing data not provided on the initial emergency report.

After 17:00 and before 07:00 the next working day (UK bank holidays are not counted as working days)

- For P1 and P2 reports: In addition to the above (which is to submit the report through the portal), please follow up the report with a call to the NCA control centre on 01925 663355 to notify them a priority report has been submitted.

The CSEA-IRP appears to be unavailable, how do I submit a priority 1 or priority 2 report?

In the event of the Industry Reporting Portal being unavailable (at any time of day) and you need to submit a P1 or P2 report, use the Priority 1 and 2 Contingency Reporting Template which can also be found on page 52-54 in this guidance document. Once you have completed the report, send it immediately to DRB@nca.gov.uk and follow up with a call to 01925 663355 to ensure they are notified of the report. At the start of the call, you will need to provide your organisation reference number, which was contained in your registration approval email. This telephone number must not be used for any other enquires or communications.



Priority level definitions can be found on page 10



Mandatory data fields

The Child Sexual Exploitation and Abuse Industry Reporting Portal and API requests data mandated by [Online Safety \(CSEA Content Reporting by Regulated User-to-User Service Providers\) Regulations 2026](#) as well as other information that may help law enforcement investigate an offence.

Schedule 1 of the Reporting Regulations outlines the information which an organisation must provide, where that information is available to the organisation.

Important: If your organisation does not hold the mandated data being requested, they must input: "Data Not Held" when submitting via the API. Mandatory fields are indicated by the red asterisks in Swagger (*)



Enum fields

Contained within the API call to submit reports are multiple fields which require inputting from a pre-set list of values.

Within the swagger 'CreateAPIReferralRequest', these fields are labelled with 'enum'. These enum lists are either approved ISO lists or made of values listed below.

The following lists for these enum fields are:

- Country - ISO 3166-1 alpha-2 country code
- Address Type - HOME, BUSINESS, SHIPPING, TECHNICAL, INCIDENT LOCATION
- Event Name - LOGIN, REGISTRATION
- ESP Escalation - Priority 1 - there is a current or immediate risk to an individual, Priority 2 - there is a possible risk to an individual in the near future or is time-sensitive, Priority 3 - other
- Incident Type - Indecent imagery of children, Indecent video of children, Audio, Messaging, Viral/Meme, URL, Multiple, Other
- Method Of Detection - A user of the platform, A third party reporter, An automated detection tool, An employee moderating the platform
- Sender Status - sender, recipient
- Country Calling Code - ITU E.164

For an API call to be successful, these fields must be filled with values from these enum lists.

All of the lists are detailed in their respective fields within the API schemas section of the Swagger page.



File Limitations

Supported file types and size limits:

Material can be uploaded in any format, with the exception of executable (.exe) files, and must be no larger than 5 GB. If you have a file that is .exe or is larger than 5 GB, please convert it to a different file type or size to enable you to submit the report with the file included. If your file continues to get blocked, contact the Service and Support desk via telephone on 0330 111 5047 (UK) / +44 161 521 8753 (International) or via email support@csea-irp.atlassian.net. The Service Desk is available 07:00-18:00hrs, 7 days a week, including weekends and UK bank holidays.

Please note, the Service and Support desk can only assist with tech queries and not the contents of a report. As such, we ask that when contacting the Service and Support desk, no details of the submitted report are discussed.